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all the ingredients of a champion side. With Kohli's mentorship and quiet backing, they transformed from perennial underachievers into deserving winners.

As Kohli remarked, this was a team of focused, composed individuals on a mission. They kept emotions in check, remained grounded, and ignored the noise. That, in many ways, became their recipe for success.

Patidar absorbed the pressures of captaincy with poise. Behind him

stood a solid backroom staff — Mo Bobat, Andy Flower and Dinesh Karthik — who kept things steady. At the auction, they went in with a clear plan: add impact. Phil Salt (403 runs), Jitesh Sharma (261 runs), and Liam Livingstone were the main additions. While Salt and Jitesh brought stability to the batting, Livingstone chipped in with a crucial cameo, 25 off 15, in the final.

The think tank understood one central truth — the team still revolved around Kohli. Their

approach was to trust the players, allow instinct to take charge, and avoid over-coaching.

That trust extended to the bowling department, where much-needed gaps were addressed.

"There was a strong, unwavering focus on assembling a quality bowling attack — that was recognised as essential from the very beginning," head coach Flower said.

Bhuvneshwar Kumar and Krunal Pandya, both experienced campaigners, were smart additions.